

Philipp Hilbert

PRODUCT MANAGER | PRODUCT OWNER

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PROFILE

Senior Product Owner and product manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries including defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments and retail. I translate complex technical and domain requirements into user stories, epics, and acceptance criteria, manage backlog refinement and sprint delivery in Jira, and align stakeholders from engineering through C-level on roadmap and vision. I lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery using Scrum, Kanban, and SAFe.

HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
- Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
- I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Product Manager, Rohde & Schwarz, Munich / Remote | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Managed a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence, owning backlog refinement, sprint planning, and stakeholder reporting for the FCAS AI and data platform.
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

Product Manager, Bundesagentur für Arbeit (Federal Employment Agency), Nuremberg / Remote |

05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

Product Owner, CLINET Platforms, Berlin | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis went from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

Product Manager, EMIL Group, Berlin | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

Product Owner Integration Team, Scheidt & Bachmann Fuel & Convenience Retail, Mönchengladbach |

09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

Product Owner (interim), Bundesdruckerei, Berlin | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government, secure data platform.

- Owned data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

Product Owner (proxy), AOK ITSCare, Frankfurt | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

Project Lead, Enercon, Wismar / Magdeburg | 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

Product Owner, Waldburg-Zeil Kliniken, Isny | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

FOUNDER TRACK

Founder and Product Manager, construct8, Limassol | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Construction staffing marketplace, zero to one alone: two-sided B2B model with anonymity-until-payment, LLM agents across the funnel, and funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

Co-Founder and Product Owner, Qcrypt AG, Berlin | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

Co-Founder, CDO and CFO, Smart Soil Technologies, Berlin | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

Founder and CFO, Kvitt Payment Solutions, Berlin | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero and taken to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

SKILLS

- **Product Ownership:** user stories, epics, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, daily stand-up, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.
- **Agile and Scaled Delivery (SDLC):** Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.
- **Product Management:** continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.
- **Stakeholder and Leadership:** stakeholder management and expectation alignment, cross-functional team leadership, C-level and executive reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.
- **Analytics and Data:** KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, data modelling.
- **Technical Environments Owned:** Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Shopware.
- **AI Products and Tooling:** LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.
- **Governance and Business:** GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, financial planning, ROI reasoning.

EDUCATION

Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur (Industrial Engineering and Management, equivalent to a Master's degree), Technische Universität Berlin (TU Berlin), Germany | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)